FREE TEMPLATES · VA 101 EP 28

Professional English for VAs

Simple English is professional English. Clear, short and polite beats deep words every time.

The 4-part email

1. **Greeting:** Hi Sarah,
2. **Why you are writing (1 line):** Quick update on the lead list.
3. **Details or question:** use bullets if there is more than one
4. **Next step and closing:** I will send the final file by 3 PM your time. Thanks!

Instead of	Try
✗ Kindly do the needful.	✓ Could you please send the file?
✗ Please revert.	✓ Please let me know.
✗ Noted with thanks.	✓ Got it, thank you! I will start now.
✗ I will update you later.	✓ I will update you by 3 PM your time.
✗ Sorry for the late reply.	✓ Thanks for your patience.
✗ Can I ask a question?	✓ Quick question: should I use +61 format?
✗ Hi (and nothing else)	✓ Hi Mark, quick question about the invoice: ...
✗ I have a problem.	✓ The form is not sending emails. I checked X and Y. Can I get access to Z?

Chat and Slack habits

☐ Send one complete message, not five short ones
☐ Reply during working hours, even just "Got it, working on it"
☐ Keep one topic in one thread
☐ Check the client's time zone before you tag or call
☐ Read it once before sending: names, dates, links

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Ready-to-use messages

Change the names and details. Keep it short.

FOLLOW-UP (NO REPLY YET)

Hi Sarah, just following up on my message from Tuesday about the lead list. Happy to adjust anything. Thanks!

RUNNING LATE

Hi Sarah, quick heads-up: the report needs 2 more hours because 30 leads had missing emails. I will send it by 5 PM your time. Is that okay?

TASK IS NOT CLEAR

Hi Mark, just to confirm before I start: you want the 50 newest contacts tagged "Hot lead", and the old ones left as is? Thanks!

ASKING FOR ACCESS

Hi Mark, to set up the email campaign I need access to the CRM and the sending domain. Could you share them through the password manager? Thanks!

SICK OR ABSENT

Hi Sarah, I am not feeling well today and will not be able to work. I moved today's tasks to tomorrow and nothing urgent is pending. I will update you in the morning.

END OF DAY UPDATE

Done today: replied to 14 inquiries, updated 32 contacts.
In progress: Melbourne lead list (60%).
Need from you: access to the Facebook page inbox.

Tip: use Grammarly, LanguageTool or an AI assistant to check your message, then make it sound like you.